

A Day in Old Delhi

Mesmerizing Old Delhi is just a mile or so (a couple of kilometers) north of Connaught Place, the modern hub of New Delhi. Unmistakably Islamic despite the nation's Hindu background, it is a thoroughly rewarding area in which to explore historic sites and markets.

MORNING From sturdy **Delhi Gate**, at the old city's southern edge, stroll up **Netaji Subhash Marg** until you see the massive ramparts of the **Red Fort** (Lal Qila) on your right. You can spend several hours visiting the exquisite halls, palaces, and museum within, including a relaxing stroll in the delightful gardens.

AFTERNOON Head west along crowded **Chandni Chowk**, perhaps dipping into the Hindu **Lal Mandir** temple, then bear south into the jumble of winding lanes that constitute one huge and vibrant market. Getting lost is part of the fun.

EVENING Find your way to **Jama Masjid** mosque, whose minarets tower above the old city. It is at its most magical around the time of evening prayers. Then it's tandoori time.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Delhi's **Indira Gandhi International Airport**, due to be connected to the new **metro** system, is 9 miles (15 km) southwest of downtown. The metro provides a hassle-free and air-conditioned way of getting around the city.

WHERE TO STAY

Rak International (inexpensive) offers a bargain in the bustling backpacker area of Paharganj. www.hotelrakinternational.com
Godwin Deluxe (moderate) is a bright, modern hotel conveniently located in Ram Nagar, near the old city. www.godwinhotels.com

Maidens (expensive) gives you a taste of real Raj-style luxury in a converted colonial mansion in Old Delhi. www.maidenshotel.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

88 Janpath, New Delhi; +91 11 2332 0008



Right Spices, dried fruits, and nuts fill the alleys of Old Delhi's Khari Baoli market

Below Jama Masjid, the largest mosque in India, was commissioned by the Mughal emperor Shah Jahan

